Easy Asian Cucumber Salad

Serves 4 · 5 min active + 20 min chill · Side / appetizer

INGREDIENTS

- 5 Persian cucumbers
- 1/2 tsp salt (for sweating)
- 1/2 tbsp sesame oil
- 3/4 tbsp light soy sauce
- 1/2 to 1 tbsp sugar
- 3/4 tbsp rice vinegar
- 1 tbsp chili oil
- 1/2 tbsp sesame seeds
- 1/2 tbsp garlic, minced (optional)

METHOD

1. Slice the cucumbers on a steep bias so the pieces come out oval rather than round. Thickness is up to you.
2. Toss the slices with 1/2 tsp salt and refrigerate at least 20 minutes (up to an hour) to pull the water out.
3. Drain, rinse under running water about 10 seconds, squeeze gently, and return to the bowl.
4. Add the sesame oil, soy sauce, sugar, rice vinegar, chili oil, sesame seeds, and garlic if using. Toss to coat and serve.

NOTES

- **The salt step is the whole trick.** Salting and chilling sweats out moisture so the cucumbers stay crunchy and the dressing doesn't end up diluted in a pool of water.
- **Don't skip the rinse.** Soy sauce is doing the seasoning later, so leaving the sweating salt on makes the salad too salty.
- **Sugar to taste.** Start at 1/2 tbsp, taste, add more if it needs balance. How much depends on how sweet or sharp the chili oil is.
- **Chili oil is the dial.** Adjust to heat preference or leave it out entirely; the salad still works on vinegar, sesame, and soy.
- **Make ahead.** Best right after tossing. If needed, keep the sliced cucumbers and the mixed dressing in separate airtight containers and combine at serving; about 2 days in the fridge.

PER SERVING (ESTIMATE)

72 cal · 5 g carbs · 1 g protein · 6 g fat · 1 g fiber · 3 g sugar · 481 mg sodium

Adapted from Farah J. Eats, farahjeats.com/recipe/easy-asian-cucumber-salad. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.